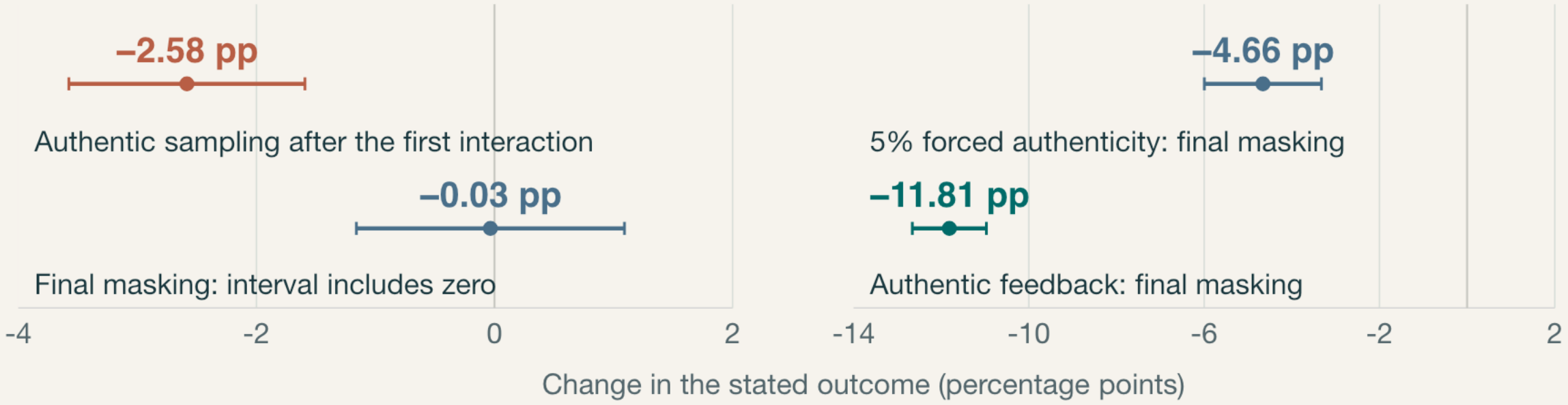
Feedback changes behaviour under unchanged opportunities

M0 / E01: fixed acceptance probabilities and environmental payoffs

Initial rejection vs acceptance

After rejection: intervention – baseline

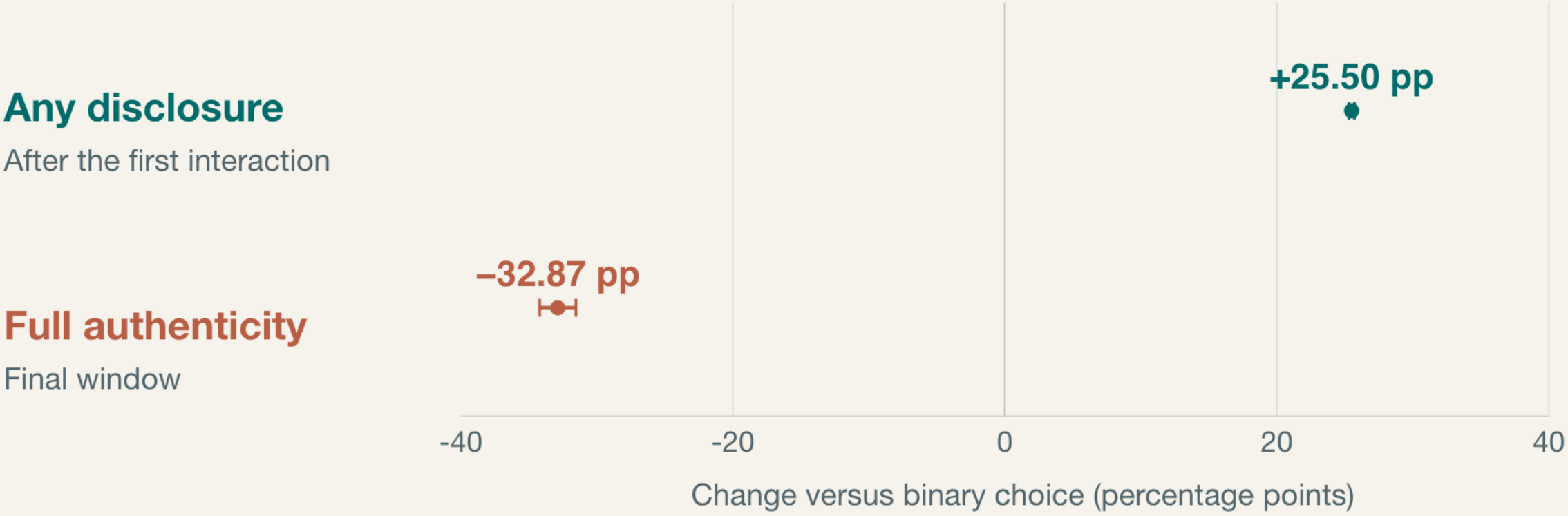


History affects sampling. Extra information changes later masking.

Five masters; p=.75/.85 pooled, λ=1. Dots show estimates; lines show 95% intervals. pp = percentage points.

More participation can coexist with less full expression

M1 / E02: graded choices minus binary choices after initial rejection

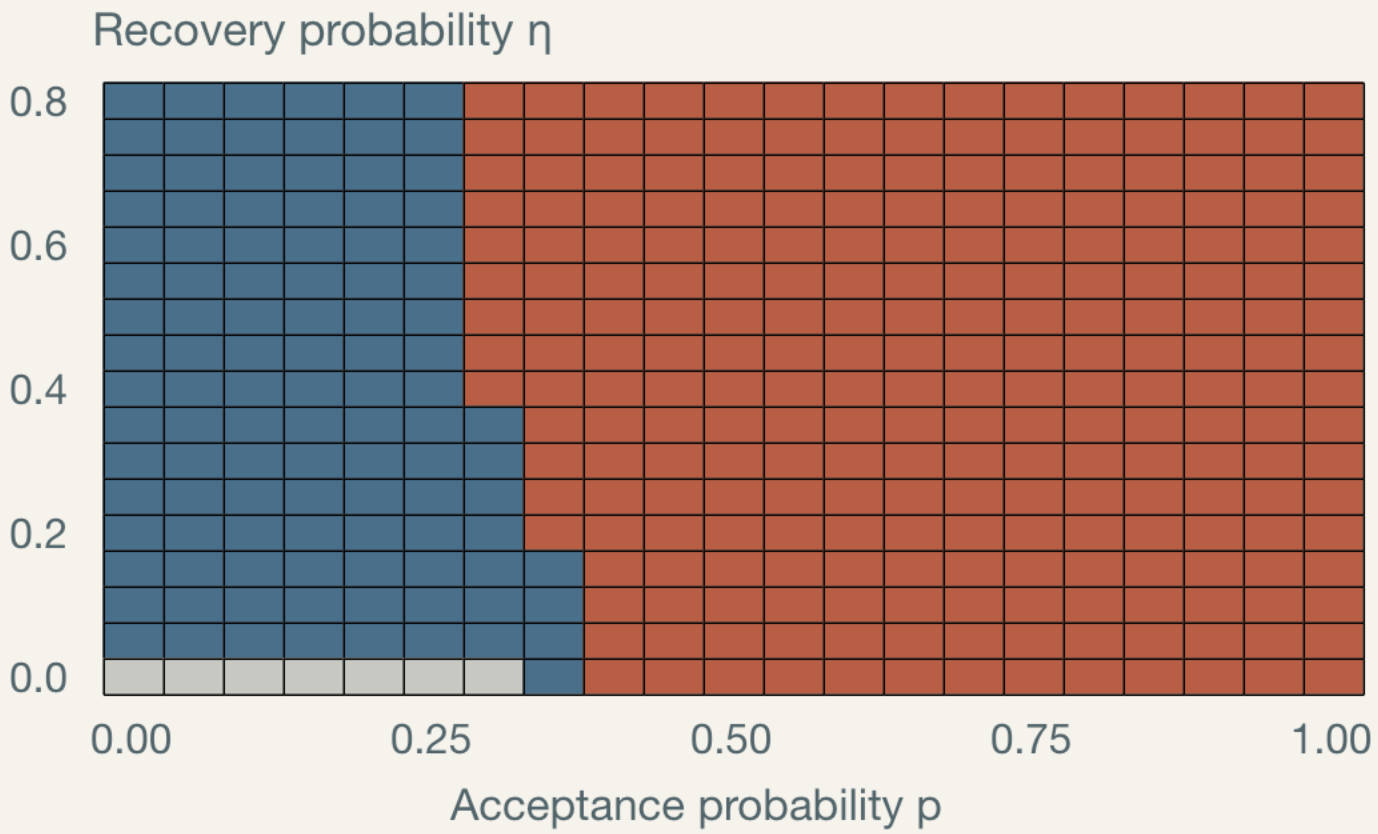


Full expression remains objectively best in these tested settings.

p=.75/.85 pooled, five masters, n=500/cell/master, T=2000. Bars are 95% intervals. Independent action values.

Learned choices can disagree with the dynamic optimum

M2 / E03: neutral-state action choice across 357 parameter settings



243 / 357

Learned masking, optimal authenticity

107 agreement

7 inconclusive

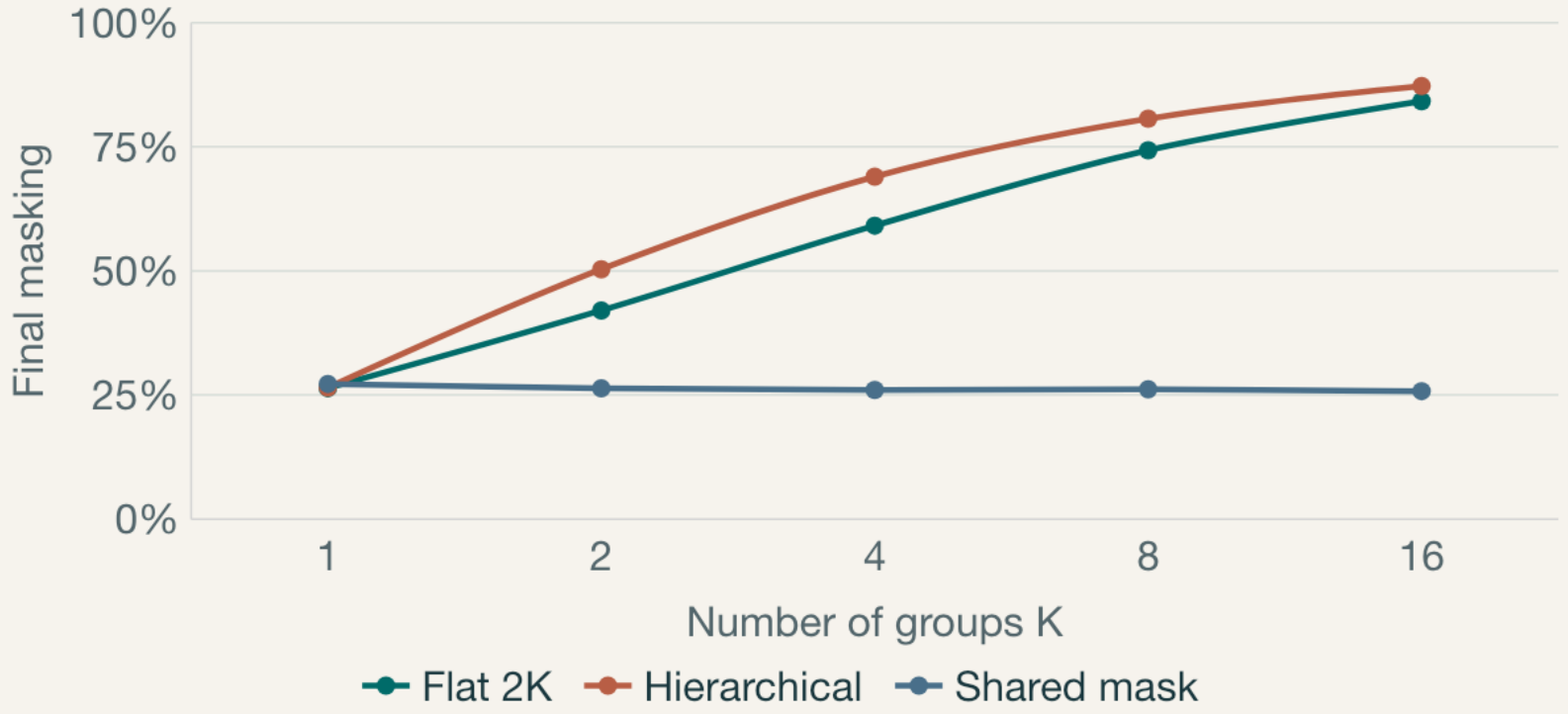
Objective authenticity threshold

Static	M2: η=0	M2: η=.8
.717	.384	.269

Baseline: 160 learners/cell/master, T=1000, five masters. Map categories use adequate Neutral visits. No smoothing.

Finding a receptive group does not ensure sustained expression

M3 / E04: the best available reward stays fixed as K increases



K = 16, flat model

84.19%

of final-window actions were masking

99.72%

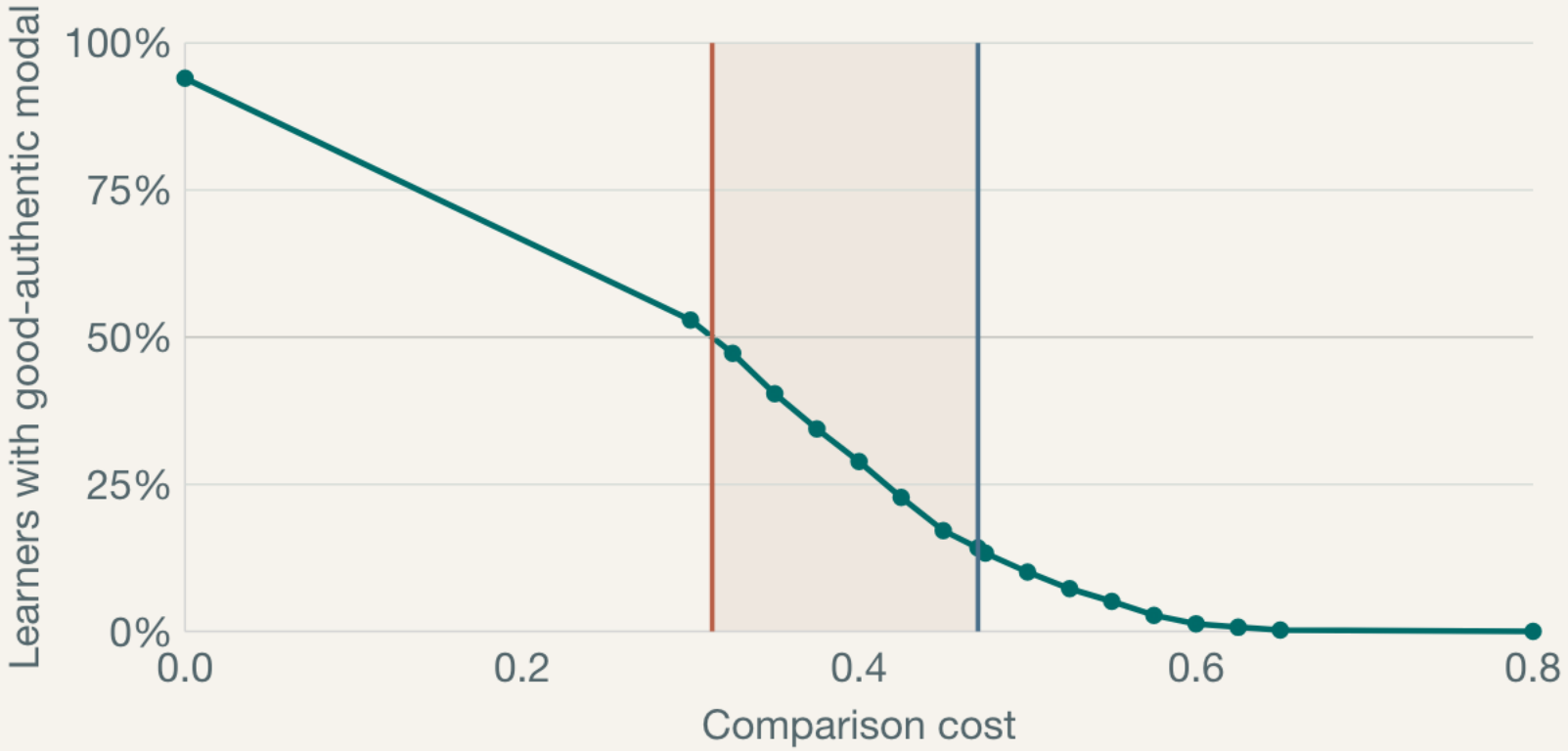
of learners experienced acceptance in the good group

The effect depends on how choices are represented.

Flat K=16–1: +57.83 pp final masking [95% CI 57.43, 58.22]. One good group, fixed identity. Five masters; n=500/cell/master, T=2000. Curves show descriptive means at discrete K.

The learned boundary occurs before objective indifference

M3 / E05: comparison cost reduces accepted authenticity in the receptive group



LEARNED

0.313

95% CI [.308, .317]

OBJECTIVE

0.471

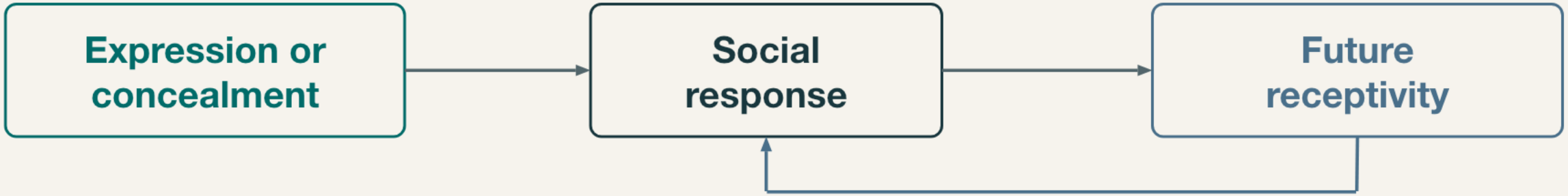
Expected payoffs are equal

Authenticity retains an objective advantage at the learned crossing.

Flat K=4, λ=1, five masters, n=500/cell/master, T=2000. Modal classification is distinct from total masking.

Could behaviour change future social receptivity?

M4: an implemented extension with formal results deferred



After this event	Future receptivity
Accepted authenticity	Increases
Rejection or masking	Decreases

Environment: changing p_t
Learner: two action values

Direction-of-change rules are model assumptions. Hysteresis is not established.

Similar concealment can arise through different processes

Discussion: observed behaviour leaves several mechanisms possible

Process	What it helps explain
Experience and feedback (M0)	Underuse of a fixed opportunity
Separate disclosure values (M1)	Participation without full expression
Persistent consequences (M2)	Why immediate reward can mislead
Context-specific learning (M3)	Encounter without sustained use

Concealment alone cannot identify the process that produced it.

These are findings in specified computational models. Mechanisms in children require empirical evidence.

What should we measure next?

Discussion: mechanisms suggest different empirical measurements

What does the child expect?	Expectations before an interaction
Which experiences change it?	Feedback and subsequent expectations
Does learning transfer?	Expression across levels and contexts
What consequences persist?	Social standing, recovery and repeated use

Specific mechanisms give us predictions we can test.

Model-derived questions for empirical study. The simulations are not calibrated to chronological age.